

Communicating to personnel

Item 4 of 9

Communicating to personnel

An organisation's cyber security policy and procedures should outline the assets that require protecting, what the threats are to those assets and the controls and guidelines for protecting them. It should guide employees on what can be shared, where and how, acceptable use procedures and the handling, storage and protection of sensitive information.

Therefore, the development of a cyber security policy must address key information relating to:

Compliance relating to
legislation and regulations

Infrastructure of systems
and processes

Employee's roles and
responsibilities

Communicating policies and procedures

Communicating the cyber security policies and procedures to relevant personnel and the way in which this has been done could greatly affect whether or not they are implemented and carried out successfully.

It can also go toward creating a positive cyber security culture and promote good practice to external stakeholders such as clients and auditors.

A structured approach to communicating cyber security policies and procedures could be as follows.

Firstly, you need to structure a communication plan to provide a framework and record of what is communicated, how, when, who by and what medium.

Next would be implementing a set of initiatives to inform employees of the cyber security program, such as online compulsory training modules or presenting policy frameworks to heads of department to inform teams.

Employees need to be engaged and follow through with the policy guidelines and procedures, so the communication may need to be gradual, consistent and regular.

Above all communication needs to be:

- clear
- concise
- relevant
- timely
- in a presentable format
- available on the most appropriate platforms and mediums.

Activity: Read

To find out more about effective communication, read the information at the following link:

<https://www.proofhub.com/articles/effective-communication>

Take any notes to summarise what you have read and keep for future reference.

Policies and procedures can be explained via training workshops, inductions, team meetings, workshops, as a compulsory aspect for new employees, or distributed via the organisation's intranet, email or sent in paper format for signature to acknowledge their responsibility for compliance; an organisation needs to ensure that employees recognise and are compliant with security best practices.

The need to be able to support this through its effective communication of the policies and procedures can also be further implemented through reminders and restrictions, for example if an employee does not change their password within the time provided then they are restricted from accessing the internet.

It is therefore important that the implementation of policies and procedures are consistently monitored, reviewed and any non-compliance is recognised and acted upon.

Activity: Watch

Read the article and watch the informative video on high level cyber policy making

<https://www.forbes.com/sites/cognitiveworld/2019/08/30/we-need-cyber-policy-now/#78789edb1e17> (43:12)

Take any notes and write down your key takeaways for discussion

Take any notes and write down your key takeaways for discussion.

The trainer/assessor will facilitate a discussion.

Activity: Read

Read the following information on how to run effective cyber security awareness training:

<https://blog.ironbastion.com.au/running-effective-security-awareness-training/>

Watch the embedded video.

Take any notes to summarise what you have read and keep for future reference.

Activity: Group work – Cyber Security team project

Divide into small groups. Ensure you divide the work equally. This will be your project team.

You are to work collaboratively as part of a cyber security team to help develop a cyber security awareness program for staff. This will include a policy, an information sheet and a training session.

The program will be eventually presented to your group in a training workshop situation (as part of the activity in the next topic).

Read the scenario:

Bamford Community College has identified from a survey that the following will need to be included in a Cyber Security Policy:

- Best organisational practices for keeping student information private and confidential
- How to set, store and change passwords
- Email security measures
- BYOD (Bring your own device) procedures and rules
- Implications of Notifiable Data Breach legislation
- The 13 Australian Privacy Principles from the Privacy Act 1988.

The program must also include an information sheet:

- Organisational expectations including how to prepare, identify, prevent, detect, respond to security incidences
- Researched information on insights from cyber security trend analysis

(for example via www.abs.gov.au or <https://clutch.co/it-services/resources/how-employees-engage-company-cybersecurity-policies>)

Ensure that the information is:

- Clear and concise
- Professionally presented
- Uses specific and industry-related terminology relating to cyber security

You will need to present the policy to staff and carry out a demonstration of at least one best cyber security practice using an appropriate technology platform to assist with promoting cyber security to teachers in their work role. Ensure you work collaboratively with your team to develop an innovative approach.

The policy must be written in a clearly structured and professionally presented document; the information sheet and training format and medium can be up to the teams.

Send an email attaching your policy and documents to your supervisor for approval and feedback (the trainer/assessor).

Your trainer/assessor will provide your group with feedback.

